

[CH0] Introduction

Saturday, March 28, 2020 8:18 AM

- Computers were originally used by scientists / the military => They were built for sheer processing power
- **Late 19th century:** Businesses (large and small) needed to process more and more data => the desk calculator industry skyrocketed
- **First half of the 20th century:** Punched-card systems gained worldwide popularity (originally developed to aid with the US census).
 - These were also the origins of IBM
- Because of military spending during WW2, the first **electronic, stored-program computers** were built (but none were actually ready in time for the war)
- After the war, computer manufacturers found a market in Governments, insurance agencies, businesses, etc
- **1945: John von Neumann** set the basic specifications for the computer in place in a report
 - These are still largely followed today